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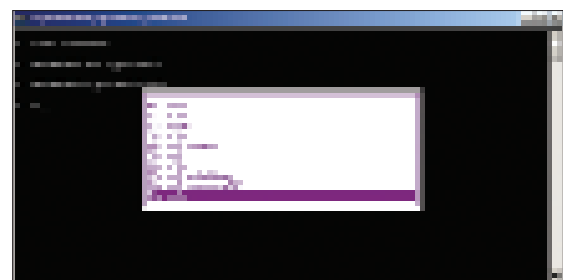
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WINDOWS COMMAND PROMPT

With Windows 2000 and then Windows XP, the use of the Windows Command prompt has been on the decline. Almost everything today is dependent on the user interface of Windows. There are still many tasks that can be done just from a Windows Command prompt and it can be handy for things like removing viruses or stubborn files that Windows Explorer can't do anything about. The command prompt can be started by going to Start > Run, entering cmd and hitting [Enter].

Command Prompt History

In the DOS days when everything ran on command prompt, there was something called Doskey, which would keep a history of all the commands entered, which could be recalled as and when required. Windows has a better and easier way to display previously entered commands. Simply press [F7] and use the up and down arrow keys to select the command from the list you want to run again. You can also use the up and down arrows without the list, to



All previous commands can be accessed by a simple shortcut

cycle through the commands. To enter the previous command, type [F3]. If you want to enter a command line number from the list, press [F9] and enter it.

Command Prompt After Running Application

Many a times, a DOS or command line based program is run through the usual Start > Run method—say something like chkdisk or a network tracer command. The program executes and then shuts the command line window with it. Ideally, we want to see what happens during the execution of an application. To do this, type the name of the application or the command after cmd /k. For example, cmd /k chkdisk d: will scan the disk, display the results and leave the command prompt window open.

Copy And Paste

Most of us have, at some point or the other, tried to copy something from and into the command prompt window but the shortcuts [Ctrl] + [C] and [Ctrl] + [V] just wouldn't work. To copy text from the command prompt, you need to first right-click on the title bar of the window and click on Mark. Now drag a box around the text you want to copy. Right-click again and the text will be copied into the



Basic changes can also be done through the Properties window

clipboard. To paste any text into the command prompt window, right click in the window itself and click Paste.

If you want to copy and paste stuff quickly, you can enable it by right clicking on the title bar for the window and then on Properties. Check the box for QuickEdit Mode. Click OK. You can choose to enable this for a single window or for all command prompt windows. Now simply drag and select the text to be copied. A single right-click will paste the contents of the clipboard to the window.

Using AutoComplete

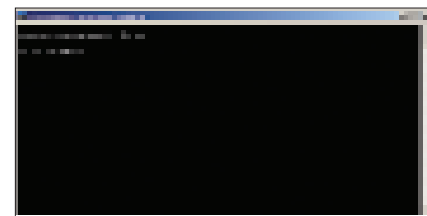
Like the Linux console, Windows's command prompt too has an auto complete feature, which allows you to complete file names without typing the entire name. Type the first few characters of the filename or folder and press [Tab]. If there is more than one result, you can use [Tab] to cycle through all the possibilities.

Full Screen Mode

If you try and run a console or DOS application that looks right when run on full screen, you can do it by pressing [Alt] + [Enter]. Use the same shortcut again to get back to the window mode.

Customising The Command Prompt

The typical grey-on-black theme can get boring. There are a few changes that can be made to the command prompt to look a little friendlier. The prompt itself can be customised, which by default displays C:\ or the path you're currently on.



the PROMPT command allows changes to be made to the command prompt

The prompt can be changed by typing PROMPT followed by the parameters. PROMPT \$P\$G will restore the prompt to the default one. Some of the parameters that can be used are as follows—
 \$D—Current date
 \$T—Current time
 \$P—Path
 \$G—
 \$V—Windows Version
 \$M—Network path for mapped drives

You can also have the text on the title bar changed. Enter the command TITLE in the command prompt, followed by the text you want to display on the title bar. For example, title %username% %date% %time% will display the currently logged in user name followed by the current date and time.

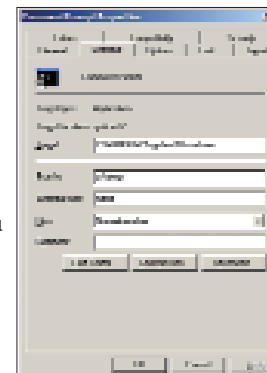
If all this seems unnecessary, and you want a change of colour, the simplest way out is to right-click on the command prompt title bar and click on Properties. The fonts, colours and layout can be changed from here.

Open Command Prompt In A Specified Directory

The command prompt, when initialised, starts in the logged in users default directory—

C:\Documents and Settings\Username.
 From there, you have to navigate using DOS commands to the respective directory, if you have to run an application or work on some files. If you want to launch the command line at a different location, first create a shortcut on your Desktop or your Quicklaunch folder by right clicking on it and clicking New > Shortcut. Enter the location of the item as C:\windows\system32

\cmd.exe. Give a name to the shortcut and click Finish create it. Right-click on the created shortcut and choose Properties. Click the Shortcut tab and enter the path where you want the command prompt to start. For example, C:\. Click OK. Double click the shortcut to run it.



By specifying a startup location, the command prompt can start at that location

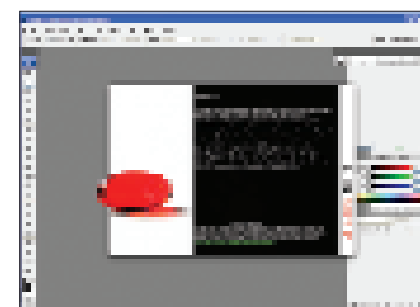
EASTER EGGS

Easter eggs are there to lighten up the mood and they do so by shocking us or making us laugh. Here are a select few Easter eggs from some of the most popular software.

Adobe Photoshop CS3

Photoshop has quite a few Easter eggs, but one of the coolest ones is the red pill. Hold down [Ctrl] and [Alt] and go to Help > About Photoshop. Instead of the default About information screen, you will now see one with a red pill on the left and text on the right saying Adobe Red Pill.

Merlin the wizard is one known character on many Photoshop releases, and in CS3, you can find him by first enabling the Layers window. Hold



Do you take the blue pill or the red?

down the [Alt] key and click on the down arrow for that window, choose Palette Options and a small window pops up, with a picture of the wizard and "Merlin Lives!"

Windows XP

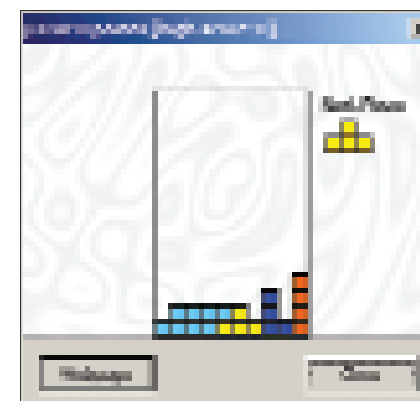
A typical Windows XP installation contains a music theme that's hidden away in a folder C:\WINDOWS\system32\oobe\images. Enter this location in the address bar on Windows Explorer as it's a hidden folder. The track is called title.wma. Double click on it to run it and enjoy the Windows Welcome music.

Create Files With No Name

If you have ever tried to create a file or folder with just a space on it, Windows will show an alert and it not allow you to create it just like with the name CON. If you try holding down the [Alt] key and enter 255, an empty space will be created. Press [Enter] and the file or folder will be created with no name.

uTorrent

uTorrent has an interesting little Easter egg in it. Start uTorrent and click on Help > About uTorrent. Click on the logo on the left top, and a sound will



Pass your time playing Tetris while your torrents download

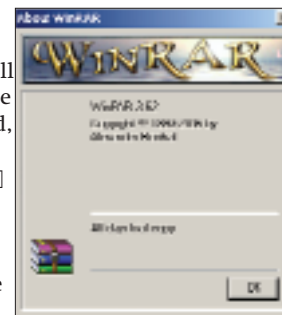
be played—something like the one used in THX trailers. An even more surprising Easter egg can be found in the same window. Press [Ctrl] + [T] and you will find a small tetris game running. Use the arrow keys to rotate and to move the blocks into place.

Notepad

Notepad is a text editor and not many believe there is an Easter egg in it. Create a new Notepad text file and type in bush hid the facts. Save the file and close it. Re-open the file to see what you find. Even if you type this app can break, you will get the same results—garbled text. This is not technically an Easter egg, but an issue.

WinRAR

Although WinRAR's just another compression utility, it also has a few hidden eggs. These can be found in the About window. First, make sure you are using the default WinRAR theme. Click on Help > About WinRAR. Click on the pile of books on the left, and you'll see them slide down. Instead, if you hold down [Ctrl] + [Shift] and click on the WinRAR logo with the background of the seashore, you'll see the waves beginning to pour in and out.



WinRAR easter egg has a pile of books sliding about

Firefox

Firefox has a silly Easter egg, which can be viewed by entering about kitchensink in the location bar (note that there's no colon). A kitchen sink made up of ASCII characters will open up with water flowing down it. You need to be connected to the Internet for this. You can also get the same result in other browsers by entering the keywords about kitchensink in Google and selecting I'm Feeling Lucky.

Counter-Strike CT-Spawn

It's not just software that come with Easter eggs, there are games as well. One of the most widely played games—Counter-Strike—has many Easter eggs built into it. One of them is in the map de_dust2. First, join the Counter-Terrorist team and type kill in the console. When you join into free fly mode, move into the walls facing the terrorist team and you will see the credits for the map. You might have to host your own server for this with free fly enabled for the map.